

CSS CHEAT SHEET

Quick reference for HTML & CSS learners

1. Basic CSS Syntax

selector { property: value; }

Example	What it does
p { color: blue; }	Makes all <p> text blue.
.box { padding: 20px; }	Targets elements with class="box".
#header { background: black; }	Targets the element with id="header".

2. Selectors

Selector	Meaning
*	All elements
p	All <p> elements
.class	Elements with a class
#id	Element with an ID
div p	p inside div
div > p	Direct child p of div
h1, h2	Both h1 and h2
input[type="text"]	Attribute selector
a:hover	Link when mouse is over it

3. Colors & Text

Property	Example
color	color: #333;
background-color	background-color: lightblue;
font-family	font-family: Arial, sans-serif;
font-size	font-size: 18px;
font-weight	font-weight: 700;
text-align	text-align: center;
line-height	line-height: 1.5;
text-decoration	text-decoration: none;

4. Box Model

content → padding → border → margin

Property	Example	Purpose
width / height	width: 300px;	Element size
padding	padding: 20px;	Space inside border
border	border: 1px solid #333;	Border around element
margin	margin: 20px;	Space outside element
box-sizing	box-sizing: border-box;	Includes padding/border in width

5. Display & Position

Property/value	Use
display: block	Starts on a new line; takes available width.
display: inline	Flows within text; width/height usually don't apply.

Property/value	Use
<code>display: inline-block</code>	Inline flow with width/height support.
<code>display: none</code>	Removes element from layout.
<code>position: relative</code>	Positions relative to its normal location.
<code>position: absolute</code>	Positions relative to nearest positioned ancestor.
<code>position: fixed</code>	Stays fixed relative to viewport.
<code>position: sticky</code>	Behaves normally, then sticks while scrolling.

6. Flexbox

```
.container { display: flex; }
```

Property	Common values	Purpose
flex-direction	row, column	Main-axis direction
justify-content	center, space-between, space-around	Aligns on main axis
align-items	center, flex-start, stretch	Aligns on cross axis
flex-wrap	wrap, nowrap	Allows items to wrap
gap	10px, 1rem	Space between flex items
flex	1, 1 200px	Controls item growth/shrink/basis

Useful pattern:

```
display: flex; justify-content: center; align-items: center; gap: 1rem;
```

7. CSS Grid

```
.grid { display: grid; }
```

Property	Example
grid-template-columns	grid-template-columns: repeat(3, 1fr);
grid-template-rows	grid-template-rows: 100px 200px;
gap	gap: 20px;
grid-column	grid-column: 1 / 3;
grid-row	grid-row: 1 / 3;
place-items	place-items: center;

8. Responsive Design

```
@media (max-width: 768px) { ... }
```

Use media queries to change styles for different screen sizes.

Unit	Typical use
px	Fixed size
%	Relative to parent
rem	Relative to root font size
em	Relative to current/parent font size
vw / vh	Viewport width / height
fr	Grid's fraction of available space

9. Backgrounds & Borders

Property	Example
background	background: #222 url("image.jpg") center/cover;
background-image	background-image: url("image.jpg");
background-size	cover / contain
border-radius	border-radius: 12px;
box-shadow	box-shadow: 0 4px 12px rgba(0,0,0,.2);

10. Common Pseudo-classes & Pseudo-elements

Selector	Purpose
:hover	Mouse pointer is over an element
:focus	Element has keyboard/input focus
:active	Element is being activated

Selector	Purpose
:first-child	First child of its parent
:nth-child(2)	Specific child position
::before	Generated content before an element's content
::after	Generated content after an element's content

11. Transitions & Transforms

transition: all 0.3s ease;

Property	Example
transition	transition: transform .3s ease;
transform: scale()	transform: scale(1.05);
transform: translate()	transform: translateY(-5px);
transform: rotate()	transform: rotate(5deg);

12. CSS Variables

```
:root { --primary: #2563eb; }
button { background: var(--primary); }
```

Variables make repeated values easier to change.

13. Cascade, Specificity & !important

Selector	Approx. specificity
element	1
.class / [attribute] / :pseudo-class	10
#id	100
inline style	1000

Tip: Prefer clear selectors over excessive !important. When rules conflict, specificity, source order, and importance affect which declaration wins.

14. Handy Reset

```
* { box-sizing: border-box; }
body { margin: 0; }
img { max-width: 100%; display: block; }
```

15. Quick Centering Recipes

Goal	CSS
Center horizontally	margin-inline: auto;
Center with Flexbox	display:flex; justify-content:center; align-items:center;
Center text	text-align:center;
Grid center	display:grid; place-items:center;

16. Mini Example

```
.card {
  width: min(90%, 400px);
  padding: 1.5rem;
  border-radius: 12px;
  box-shadow: 0 4px 12px rgba(0,0,0,.15);
  background: white;
}

.card:hover {
  transform: translateY(-4px);
  transition: transform .2s ease;
}
```

Remember: CSS = selector + property + value. Practice by changing one property at a time and inspecting the result in your browser.